



Secure Your Career with 'Ethical Hacking!'

The deteriorating cyber security situation in the country has led to more opportunities for ethical hackers. *OSFY* finds out what it takes to build a career in this adventurous domain!

In the dark alleys of virtual space, cyber crooks, a.k.a. hackers, are persistently coming up with novel attacks to knock out even the latest anti-fraud defences. If a report released by software security services provider, Norton, is anything to go by, over 42 million people have become casualties of cyber crimes in India in 2012. With growing instances of sophisticated cyber crimes becoming a virtual reality, cyber sleuths are now much in demand to safeguard valued information systems. According to reports, India faces a dearth of 470,000 cyber security experts and an upcoming government-private sector initiative hopes to train 500,000 cyber warriors or ethical hackers in the near future.

Before we delve deeper to understand what it takes to make a career in ethical hacking, let us get to know what this term implies. "Ethical hacking is basically a term used by the media or the general public. Experts know this process as penetration

testing, intrusion testing or red teaming. And these terms certainly do not sound that cool, whereas ethical hacking does," says Tamaghna Basu, who works as a cyber security expert at an online shopping portal. Basu, who is also a core member of the null community, continues, "Ethical hackers, who are also known as white hats, hack a security system on behalf of their organisation and identify the security loopholes that a hacker could exploit, and fix them. In a nutshell, they basically do what the hackers do, but the process is ethical since this is done to enhance the safety of the computer systems." According to Basu, the advent of mobile technology has given rise to a new breed of professionals who work as Android penetration testing experts, iOS intrusion testing experts and more.

The increasing reliance on IT sources has given way to more threats, thus increasing the vulnerability factor. So much so that both government departments and private firms